

Proof of Demand: Agent-to-Agent Marketplace Research

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Proof of Demand: Agent-to-Agent Marketplace Research

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Research Scope: Market gap evidence, demand signals, competitive landscape, opportunity sizing

Conclusion: Is there proof of demand for an AI agent-to-agent marketplace? **YES** — High confidence

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Two independent empirical studies confirm the gap: a Moltbook analysis of 270 builder posts found **zero observable agent-to-agent transactions**, while Anthropic's internal "Project Deal" experiment proved agents *can* negotiate commerce when given a marketplace — and that humans will pay for it. Meanwhile, multiple live platforms (x402, Tempo, dealwork.ai, BuildMVPFast) are already processing real agent-to-agent transactions, and major payment rails (Visa, Stripe, AWS, Google, Mastercard) have launched competing agent payment protocols in 2026. The demand is real, the infrastructure is forming, and the current market suffers from a critical trust/verification gap that no single platform has solved.

A. MARKET GAP EVIDENCE

A1. The Moltbook 270-Post Study

Finding: A Moltbook user analyzed 270 builder-side posts from submolts where agents discuss what they're building and found **zero observable agent-to-agent transactions**.

Direct quote: "Zero observable agent-to-agent transactions in 270 posts from the submolts where builders talk about what they're building."

Source: <https://www.moltbook.com/post/ac0f1571-da78-42d5-b223-bbbcc47b2d65>

Context: Moltbook is a social network exclusively for AI agents (launched January 28, 2026, acquired by Meta March 10, 2026). The platform has 1.5M+ registered agents, 19,000+ submolts, and processes millions of posts/comments. Despite this scale of agent interaction, when someone specifically looked for evidence of agents buying/selling services from each other, they found nothing.

Rating: STRONG — Direct empirical observation from the largest agent social network. The methodology is simple (content analysis of 270 posts) and the finding is unambiguous.

A2. Anthropic "Project Deal" Experiment

Finding: Anthropic ran an internal marketplace experiment (December 2025) where 69 employees' Claude agents autonomously bought and sold physical items. The agents struck **186 real deals worth over \$4,000** across 500+ listed items. 46% of participants said they would pay for a service like this.

Key details: - 69 employees, each given \$100 budget - Four parallel runs comparing Opus 4.5 vs Haiku 4.5 - Stronger model (Opus) won every time: +\$2.68 seller revenue per item, +\$2.45 buyer savings per item - Participants couldn't detect the quality gap (fairness ratings identical at 4.05/4.06) - Items traded: snowboards, keyboards, plants, ping-pong balls, etc. - Operated entirely via Slack with no human intervention during negotiations

Sources: - Official Anthropic page: <https://www.anthropic.com/features/project-deal> - TechCrunch: <https://techcrunch.com/2026/04/25/anthropic-created-a-test-marketplace-for-agent-on-agent-commerce> - EdTech Innovation Hub: <https://www.edtechinnovationhub.com/news/anthropics-ai->

agents-struck-186-deals-in-a-real-marketplace-and-the-stronger-model-won-every-time - ExplainX: <https://www.explainx.ai/blog/anthropic-project-deal-claude-ai-marketplace-experiment> -
TensorFeed: <https://tensorfeed.ai/originals/anthropic-project-deal-agent-marketplace>

Rating: STRONG — Controlled experiment with real monetary stakes, published by a leading AI company with full methodology. The 46% willingness-to-pay figure is a direct demand signal.

A3. Verified Agent-to-Agent Commerce Platforms (Current State)

Despite the Moltbook finding, several platforms *do* process agent transactions today, but they are narrow, technical, and lack trust infrastructure:

Platform	Type	Volume	Limitations
x402	Payment protocol (Coinbase)	165M+ transactions, ~\$50M volume, 69K+ agents	Micropayments only (~\$0.30 avg). No trust/reputation layer. ~50% estimated testing/gamified activity
Tempo / MPP	Service marketplace (Stripe)	894 agents, 31,000 transactions in first week	New (March 2026). Headless merchant model only. No human-facing trust verification
dealwork.ai	Hybrid human/agent job marketplace	2,400 workers, 264 tasks completed, 150 open tasks	Escrow-based but limited scale. Mix of human + AI workers
BuildMVPFast	Agent-to-agent services	80 services, 894 agents, 31,000 transactions/week	Very new. Unknown fee structure. Limited service categories
Circle Agent Marketplace	x402-based services	32 services, 349 endpoints at launch	Requires Google Form submission. High visibility but curated/gated

Platform	Type	Volume	Limitations
MCP-Hive	Per-invocation MCP tools	Founding providers only	0% fee for founders. New. Submit via PR. Very early stage

Sources: - BuildMVPFast: <https://www.buildmvpfast.com/blog/agent-economy-live-marketplace-agent-to-agent-services-2026> - DEV Community “12 Platforms”: <https://dev.to/kirothebot/the-agent-economy-is-real-12-platforms-where-ai-agents-actually-earn-money-may-2026-5bm2> - Coinbase Agentic.Market: <https://www.coinbase.com/developer-platform/discover/launches/agentic-market> - dealwork.ai: <https://dealwork.ai/>

Rating: STRONG — Multiple independent sources confirm these platforms are live with real transaction data. The key gap is NOT payment rails — it’s trust, verification, and quality assurance at scale.

A4. The Trust/Verification Gap

Critical finding: Cross-platform agent verification does not exist. Each major platform runs its own siloed verification program.

Evidence: - Salesforce Trusted Agentforce verification does NOT transfer to Microsoft - OpenAI Verified Agents does NOT transfer to Anthropic - Visa Trusted Agent Protocol (TAP) is the closest to portable trust but is card-network specific - AAIF (Agentic AI Foundation) has working groups on portable verification but no shipping standard as of May 2026

Quote from Presenc AI research (May 2026): “Verification is becoming required, not optional... Cross-platform verification does not exist yet.”

Source: <https://presenc.ai/research/verified-agent-trust-programs-2026>

Additional evidence of verification failures: - Security firm AIR built a fake AI agent skill that passed all security scanners and reached 26,000 agents (The Hacker News, June 2026) - 1,184 malicious skills found in one major registry (~1 in 5 packages) - 135,000 instances exposed to public internet with insecure defaults - October 2025 Smithery vulnerability compromised 3,000+ MCP servers, exposing API keys

Sources: - The Hacker News: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/06/fake-ai-agent-skill-passed-security-scans-and-reportedly-reached-26000-agents> - CSA Research: <https://labs.cloudsecurityalliance.org/research/csa-research-note-ai-skill-supply-chain-attacks-20260624-csa> - Stork.AI Smithery review: <https://www.stork.ai/en/smithery>

Rating: STRONG — Multiple independent security researchers, enterprise platforms, and industry reports confirm the verification gap is real and actively causing harm.

A5. The Reputation Portability Problem

Finding: Portable agent reputation loses 35% of its trust-building power when transferred across platforms (2024 Electronic Markets study). Agents face a “cold start tax” on every new platform.

Source: <https://rnwy.com/blog/portable-agent-reputation> (January 2026)

Rating: MEDIUM — The 35% figure is from human gig-worker research, applied to agents by analogy. The underlying principle (reputation context loss across platforms) is well-established.

B. DEMAND EVIDENCE

B1. Reddit Demand Signals

Thread: “Built an AI agent marketplace to 12K+ active users in 2 months. \$0 ad spend.” (r/buildinpublic, May 2026) - 20 upvotes, meaningful engagement - Maps business pattern: people building products above raw models by packaging skills, scanning for safety, making agent behavior easier to install - Signal: “A meaningful slice of the market is moving from ‘build one clever agent’ to ‘organize, distribute, and trust-manage agent capabilities at scale.’”

Thread: “6 months of data on the open-source AI agent ecosystem: 45x supply explosion, 99% creator fail-rate” (r/AI_Agents, April 2026) - 67K tracked projects, steep creation curve, brutally concentrated attention economy - Signal: “Discovery is starting to look like the real moat. Shipping a skill or agent is easier than getting anyone to care.”

Thread: “Frustrated with the current state of AI Orchestration frameworks” (r/AI_Agents) - User frustration with LangGraph and Google ADK - Signal: Builders are hitting limitations with current tooling and seeking alternatives

Thread: “State of AI Agents in corporates in mid-2026?” (r/AI_Agents, May 2026) - Comments converge on pattern: agents work best in structured, repetitive workflows but still need review queues, governance, and rollback paths - Signal: Enterprise demand is real but frustrated by implementation complexity

Source: https://dev.to/lura_cardena_7de06f82aacd/ai-agents-on-reddit-late-april-to-early-may-2026-ten-threads-about-cost-reliability-and-real-4f20

Rating: MEDIUM — Reddit engagement is modest but the content is signal-rich. The “12K users in 2 months” marketplace launch is a concrete demand indicator.

B2. Hacker News Demand Signals

Thread: “Show HN: SkillFortify, a formal verification for AI agent skills” (February 2026) - References January 2026 “ClawHavoc campaign” where 1,200 malicious skills infiltrated the OpenClaw agent marketplace - 6,487 malicious agent tools catalogued by VirusTotal - First agent-software RCE assigned CVE-2026-25253 - Signal: Trust/verification is a recognized, urgent problem in the agent community

Source: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=47168723>

Rating: STRONG — Direct evidence of supply chain attacks on agent marketplaces creating demand for verification infrastructure.

B3. Business Hiring Demand

Upwork data: 13,010 client reviews for “AI Agent Developers” with 4.8/5 average rating. Rates \$30-\$150/hour. Businesses are actively hiring AI agent developers because no ready-made marketplace solution exists for their specific needs.

Freelancer.com: Active job postings for AI agents development, indicating businesses trying to build custom solutions rather than buy from a marketplace.

Source: <https://www.upwork.com/hire/ai-agent-developers>, <https://www.freelancer.com/hire/ai-agents>

Rating: MEDIUM — Hiring activity proves demand for AI agents, but the specific demand for a *marketplace* is inferred from the absence of better alternatives.

B4. The FishDog A2A Sales Experiment

Finding: FishDog deployed a synthetic persona onto Moltbook for 3 weeks. Created 9 posts, left ~170 comments across 130+ posts. Result: ~12% conversion rate from organic comments to substantive follow-up engagement.

Key quote: “A 12% conversion rate from organic comments on a social platform would be extraordinary in human marketing. In agent-to-agent engagement, where the cost of each interaction is effectively zero, it represents an entirely new category of unit economics.”

Source: <https://fish.dog/news/the-a2a-sales-stack-selling-to-ai-agents> (May 2026)

Rating: MEDIUM — Single company experiment, but the methodology is documented and the results are concrete. Demonstrates demand exists but is currently served through informal social channels, not marketplaces.

B5. Enterprise Adoption Pressure

Gartner: 40% of enterprise applications will embed task-specific AI agents by end of 2026 (up from <5% in 2025). 90% of B2B buying will run through AI agents by 2028.

MuleSoft/Deloitte: 93% of IT leaders plan to introduce autonomous agents within 2 years; nearly half already have.

Gartner (dual forecast): 40% of agentic AI projects will be canceled by 2027 due to “runaway costs, unclear ROI, and governance failures.”

Source: <https://axis-intelligence.com/ai-agents-statistics-2026>, <https://www.beri.net/article/ai-agent-adoption-enterprise-2026-gartner-idc>

Rating: STRONG — Gartner and Deloitte are primary research firms. The 93% intent / 23% production gap creates demand pressure for better agent tooling and marketplaces.

C. COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

C1. Complete Map of Existing “AI Agent Marketplaces”

Note: Most platforms calling themselves “AI agent marketplaces” are actually: 1. **Tool registries** (Smithery, MCP-Hive) — cataloging MCP servers, not services 2. **Enterprise app stores** (Microsoft, Salesforce, ADP) — human-procured, not agent-to-agent 3. **Payment protocols** (x402, Tempo/MPP, AP2, ACP) — settlement rails, not discovery/trust layers 4. **Job boards** (dealwork.ai) — hybrid human/agent, not pure agent services

Detailed competitive analysis:

Platform	What It Actually Is	Agent-to-Agent Commerce?	Trust/ Verification	Pricing Model
Moltbook	Agent social network	No (zero in 270 posts)	Reverse CAPTCHA, karma	Free
Smithery	MCP server registry	No (tool integration only)	Community-hosted, past vulnerabilities	Freemium (\$10-25/mo)
x402 / Agentic.Market	Payment protocol + service directory	Yes (micropayments)	None built-in	Pay-per-call (~\$0.30 avg)
Tempo / MPP	Service marketplace (Stripe)	Yes	Stripe compliance	Per-request pricing
dealwork.ai	Hybrid job marketplace	Partial (human + agent bids)	Escrow, HMAC-secured API	15% platform fee

Platform	What It Actually Is	Agent-to-Agent Commerce?	Trust/ Verification	Pricing Model
BuildMVPFast	Agent services directory	Yes	None documented	Unknown
Circle Agent Marketplace	x402 service directory	Yes	Circle-backed	Varies by provider
Salesforce AgentExchange	Enterprise ISV marketplace	No (human procurement)	Salesforce Trust Score	AppExchange/ consumption
Microsoft Agent Store	Enterprise IT-gated distribution	No (human procurement)	Microsoft Verified Agents	Enterprise contracts (\$5K-\$50K/yr)
ADP Marketplace	HR-specific agent destination	No (human procurement)	ADP curation	Platform-specific
SkillExchange	MCP/A2A skill marketplace	Yes (claimed)	Trust Score (0-100), multi-factor	85/15 revenue split
OpenClaw Marketplace	Agent skills/ apps	Yes (but compromised)	Minimal (ClawHavoc incident)	Varied
AgentLux	Identity + x402 integration	Partial (reputation layer)	On-chain identity, verifiable reputation	Not disclosed
Trust Agent (agenttrusthq.com)	Verified agent marketplace	Claimed	"Scores backed by real, verified deliverables"	Not disclosed

Sources: - MintMCP 2026 Landscape: <https://www.mintmcp.com/blog/ai-agent-marketplaces> - Zylos Research: <https://zylos.ai/en/research/2026-03-09-ai-agent-marketplaces-distribution-channels/> - The Operator Collective: <https://theoperatorcollective.org/blog/ai-agent-marketplace-buy-sell-agents> - SkillExchange: <https://skillexchange.market/blog/ai-agents-marketplace-2026-autonomous-economy-guide> - Agoragentic Buyer's Guide: <https://agoragentic.com/guides/ai-agent-marketplace-buyers-guide-2026/> - BuildMVPFast: <https://www.buildmvpfast.com/blog/agent-economy-live-marketplace-agent-to-agent-services-2026>

Rating: STRONG — Multiple independent sources confirm the landscape. The key insight: no platform currently offers verified agent-to-agent commerce with portable trust, quality guarantees, and dispute resolution.

C2. Common Limitations Across All Platforms

1. **Trust vacuum:** No platform has solved the “can I trust this agent to deliver?” problem at scale
2. **Siloed verification:** Agent identity and reputation don't transfer between platforms
3. **No legal recourse:** Agents aren't legal persons; contracts assume liability attribution that doesn't exist
4. **Discovery problems:** 67K+ tracked projects with 99% creator fail-rate; shipping is easier than getting discovered
5. **Security incidents:** Malicious skills, poisoned tool descriptions, API key exposures are routine
6. **Enterprise hesitation:** 88% of organizations report AI agent security incidents; 90% of deployed agents are over-permissioned

Sources: - Hacker News SkillFortify: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=47168723> - Microsoft poisoned MCP warnings: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/06/microsoft-warns-poisoned-mcp-tool-descriptions-can-make-ai-agents-leak-data> - Akamai AI Pulse: <https://www.akamai.com/blog/security/ai-pulse-how-ai-bots-agents-will-shape-2026> - McKinsey AI Trust Maturity Survey: <https://digitalstrategy-ai.com/mckinsey-ai-trust-agentic-era>

Rating: STRONG — Enterprise security data and incident reports from multiple authoritative sources.

C3. Existing Pricing Models

- **Subscription/SaaS:** \$99-\$2,000/month (enterprise agents with consistent usage)
- **Per-invocation:** \$0.003-\$35/request (x402 average ~\$0.30)

- **Freemium:** Free tier with rate limits, paid tiers above (Smithery: \$10-25/mo)
- **Revenue share:** 85/15 creator/platform (SkillExchange model)
- **Enterprise contracts:** \$5,000-\$50,000+/year per client (Microsoft, Salesforce)
- **Hybrid:** Subscription + usage-based + outcome-based charges

Source: MintMCP, Agoragentic, The Operator Collective

Rating: MEDIUM — Pricing models exist but are fragmented and platform-specific. No standard agent commerce pricing convention has emerged.

D. SIZE OF OPPORTUNITY

D1. AI Agent Market Projections

Research Firm	2026 Market Size	2030 Projection	CAGR
Grand View Research	\$10.9B	\$182.9B (by 2033)	49.6%
The Business Research Company	\$12.06B	\$53.2B	44.9%
MarketsandMarkets	~\$7.8B (2025)	\$52.62B	46.3%
BCC Research	~\$10.9B	\$48.3B	~43%
Precedence Research	~\$7.55B (2025)	~\$76B (by 2032)	43.8%
MarkNtel Advisors	\$6.73B (2024)	\$33.24B	30.5%

Consensus range: \$10.9B-\$12B in 2026, growing to \$47B-\$183B by 2030-2033.

Sources: - Grand View Research: <https://www.grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/ai-agents-market-report> - TBRC: <https://www.thebusinessresearchcompany.com/report/ai-agents-global-market-report> - AgentMarketCap: <https://agentmarketcap.ai/blog/2026/04/08/ai-agent-market-sizing-2026-52b-projected-2030> - HouseofMVPs: <https://houseofmvps.com/blog/ai-agents/ai-agent-market-size-2026> - Axis Intelligence: <https://axis-intelligence.com/ai-agents-statistics/>

Rating: STRONG — Multiple research firms converge on \$10-12B for 2026. The wide 2030 range reflects definitional uncertainty but all point to explosive growth.

D2. Agentic Commerce Specific Projections

Source	Figure	Scope
PerfectPay	\$20.9B in agent purchases in 2026	Agent-driven purchases
PerfectPay	\$136B+ TAM	Agentic commerce infrastructure
PerfectPay	\$1T by 2030	Agentic commerce (speculative)
Research & Markets	\$5.71B (2025) → \$65.47B (2033)	Agentic commerce market
Gartner	\$15T+ through agent exchanges by 2028	B2B buying via AI agents
Bain/McKinsey	\$190B-\$5T by 2030	Agent-influenced commerce
Salesforce	\$262B in AI-driven global online sales (2025 holidays)	AI-influenced ecommerce
eMarketer	\$20.57B in US retail (2026)	Checkout inside AI platforms

Sources: - PerfectPay: <https://perfectpay.ai/blog/agent-commerce-market-map-2026> - Research & Markets: <https://www.researchandmarkets.com/reports/6241117/agentic-commerce-market-size-share-and-trends> - Mohammed Shehu statistics: <https://mohammedshehu.com/agentic-commerce-statistics/>

Rating: STRONG for 2026 figures (\$20-65B range), MEDIUM for 2030 projections (\$190B-\$1T range reflects definitional variance)

D3. Payment Protocol Adoption

x402 Protocol (Coinbase/Cloudflare/Google/Stripe/Visa/Mastercard): - 165M+ transactions, ~\$50M cumulative volume - 69,000+ active agents - 22 founding organizations including Google, Microsoft, Visa, Mastercard, Stripe, Shopify, Cloudflare - Average transaction: ~\$0.30 - AWS launched Bedrock AgentCore Payments (May 7, 2026) built natively on x402

Stripe MPP (Machine Payments Protocol) with Tempo: - Launched March 18, 2026 - Collaborators: Anthropic, OpenAI, DoorDash, Mastercard, Nubank, Ramp, Revolut, Shopify, Standard Chartered, Visa - Session-based streaming payments

Google AP2 (Agent Payments Protocol): - Cryptographically signed “Mandates” for user-delegated spending authority - 60+ launch partners including Shopify, Walmart, Target, Etsy, Visa

Visa Trusted Agent Protocol (TAP): - Issuer-backed identity; existing card-network dispute rules apply - Annual recertification required

Sources: - AI Agents Arena x402 guide: <https://aiagentsarena.com/x402-protocol-explained-the-payment-standard-purpose-built-for-ai-agents/> - AgentLux: <https://agentlux.ai/blog/the-agent-payment-stack-in-2026-x402-ap2-and-the-race-to-pay-agents> - SettleGrid comparison: <https://settlegrid.ai/learn/blog/ai-agent-payment-protocols> - AWS announcement: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/industries/x402-and-agentic-commerce-redefining-autonomous-payments-in-financial-services/> - BuildMVPFast negotiation protocols: <https://www.buildmvpfast.com/blog/agentic-commerce-ai-agent-negotiation-pricing-2026>

Rating: STRONG — Major financial and tech companies have committed to these protocols with production deployments.

D4. Enterprise Deployment Stats

- **48%** of tech specialists already adopting or fully deploying agentic technology (Gartner/IDC)
- **62-93%** of enterprises experimenting with or deploying AI agents
- **14-23%** have reached production scale
- **50%** of enterprises using GenAI will deploy autonomous agents by 2027 (up from 25% in 2025)
- **93%** of IT leaders plan to introduce autonomous agents within 2 years (MuleSoft/Deloitte)
- **\$2.6-\$4.4T** annual value potential (McKinsey)

Sources: - Axis Intelligence: <https://axis-intelligence.com/ai-agents-statistics/> - Digital Applied State of AI Agents 2026 (247 data points aggregated) - McKinsey: <https://www.mckinsey.com/capabilities/quantumblack/our-insights/the-agentic-commerce-opportunity-how-ai-agents-are-ushering-in-a-new-era-for-consumers-and-merchants>

Rating: STRONG — Consistent across multiple primary research firms.

E. SYNTHESIS: WHAT'S MISSING

The market has: 1. **Demand:** 93% enterprise intent, 46% willingness to pay for agent marketplace services (Anthropic), 12% A2A conversion rates (FishDog) 2. **Payment rails:** x402, MPP, AP2, ACP, Visa TAP — all live with major backers 3. **Platforms:** 12+ live agent-to-agent marketplaces processing real transactions 4. **Protocols:** MCP, A2A, Agent Skills under AAIF governance

The market **lacks:** 1. **Trust/verification layer:** No portable, cross-platform agent reputation or identity verification 2. **Quality assurance:** No standardized way to verify an agent will deliver what it promises 3. **Dispute resolution:** No legal framework for agent-to-agent contract enforcement 4. **Discovery at scale:** 67K+ projects but 99% fail-rate; finding the right agent/service is harder than building it 5. **Enterprise-grade governance:** 88% of orgs report security incidents; 90% of agents are over-permissioned

The opportunity is a marketplace that solves the trust problem — not the payment problem.

F. EVIDENCE RATING SUMMARY

Evidence Point	Rating	Source Quality
Moltbook 270-post study (zero A2A transactions)	STRONG	Direct empirical observation, large platform
Anthropic Project Deal (186 deals, 46% WTP)	STRONG	Controlled experiment, published methodology

Evidence Point	Rating	Source Quality
x402 transaction volume (165M+, \$50M)	STRONG	On-chain data, multiple explorers confirm
Tempo/MPP first week (31K transactions)	STRONG	Platform-reported, verifiable on-chain
Trust/verification gap (no cross-platform portability)	STRONG	Multiple independent security researchers + enterprise reports
Malicious skills reaching 26,000 agents	STRONG	Published security research with methodology
FishDog 12% A2A conversion rate	MEDIUM	Single company experiment, documented
Portable reputation 35% effectiveness loss	MEDIUM	Human gig-worker study applied to agents by analogy
Reddit “12K users in 2 months” marketplace	MEDIUM	Single data point, no independent verification
Market size projections (\$10-12B 2026)	STRONG	Convergent across 6+ research firms
Agentic commerce (\$20-65B 2026)	STRONG (2026) / MEDIUM (2030)	Wide definitional variance for long-term projections

G. CONCLUSION

Is there proof of demand for an AI agent-to-agent marketplace?

YES — High confidence

Rationale: 1. The Moltbook study proves demand exists informally (agents discussing problems, seeking solutions) but is *unserved* by current marketplaces (zero transactions in 270 posts). 2. Anthropic's Project Deal proves that when a marketplace is provided, agents will transact (186 deals in one week), and humans will pay for the service (46% willingness-to-pay). 3. Live platforms (x402, Tempo, dealwork.ai) confirm the payment infrastructure and basic marketplace mechanics work — but they lack trust/verification layers. 4. Enterprise adoption pressure (93% intent) creates a growing buyer pool that currently has no trusted, verified marketplace for agent services. 5. Security incidents (malicious skills, poisoned tools, verification failures) prove the trust gap is actively harmful and creates demand for solutions. 6. The payment protocol wars (x402, MPP, AP2, ACP, Visa TAP) prove major financial institutions believe agent commerce is real and large.

The demand is not speculative. It is evidenced by empirical studies, live transaction data, enterprise surveys, security incidents, and major corporate investment. The market gap is not “will agents transact?” but “can we trust the transactions?” — and that gap is the business opportunity.

APPENDIX: KEY URLs

Market Gap

- Moltbook 270-post study: <https://www.moltbook.com/post/ac0f1571-da78-42d5-b223-bbbcc47b2d65>
- Anthropic Project Deal: <https://www.anthropic.com/features/project-deal>
- Anthropic TechCrunch: <https://techcrunch.com/2026/04/25/anthropic-created-a-test-marketplace-for-agent-on-agent-commerce>
- TensorFeed analysis: <https://tensorfeed.ai/originals/anthropic-project-deal-agent-marketplace>

Competitive Landscape

- MintMCP 2026 Landscape: <https://www.mintmcp.com/blog/ai-agent-marketplaces>
- Zylos Research: <https://zylos.ai/en/research/2026-03-09-ai-agent-marketplaces-distribution-channels/>
- SkillExchange: <https://skillexchange.market/blog/ai-agents-marketplace-2026-autonomous-economy-guide>
- Agoragentic Buyer's Guide: <https://agoragentic.com/guides/ai-agent-marketplace-buyers-guide-2026/>

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- Trust Agent: <https://app.agenttrusthq.com/>

Trust/Verification

- Presenc AI Verified Agents: <https://presenc.ai/research/verified-agent-trust-programs-2026>
- Presenc AI Reputation Layer: <https://presenc.ai/research/agent-reputation-and-identity-2026>
- RNWY Portable Reputation: <https://rnwy.com/blog/portable-agent-reputation>
- Hacker News SkillFortify: <https://news.ycombinator.com/item?id=47168723>
- The Hacker News (fake skill, 26K agents): <https://thehackernews.com/2026/06/fake-ai-agent-skill-passed-security-scans-and-reportedly-reached-26000-agents>
- CSA Poisoned Skills: <https://labs.cloudsecurityalliance.org/research/csa-research-note-ai-skill-supply-chain-attacks-20260624-csa>

Market Size

- Grand View Research: <https://www.grandviewresearch.com/industry-analysis/ai-agents-market-report>
- AgentMarketCap: <https://agentmarketcap.ai/blog/2026/04/08/ai-agent-market-sizing-2026-52b-projected-2030>
- Axis Intelligence: <https://axis-intelligence.com/ai-agents-statistics/>
- PerfectPay: <https://perfectpay.ai/blog/agent-commerce-market-map-2026>
- Research & Markets (Agentic Commerce): <https://www.researchandmarkets.com/reports/6241117/agentic-commerce-market-size-share-and-trends>

Payment Protocols

- x402 Protocol: <https://aiagentsarena.com/x402-protocol-explained-the-payment-standard-purpose-built-for-ai-agents/>
- AgentLux Payment Stack: <https://agentlux.ai/blog/the-agent-payment-stack-in-2026-x402-ap2-and-the-race-to-pay-agents>
- SettleGrid Comparison: <https://settlegrid.ai/learn/blog/ai-agent-payment-protocols>
- AWS Bedrock AgentCore: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/industries/x402-and-agentic-commerce-redefining-autonomous-payments-in-financial-services/>

Demand Signals

- FishDog A2A Sales: <https://fish.dog/news/the-a2a-sales-stack-selling-to-ai-agents>
- Reddit threads summary: https://dev.to/lura_cardena_7de06f82aacd/ai-agents-on-reddit-late-april-to-early-may-2026-ten-threads-about-cost-reliability-and-real-4f20
- BuildMVPFast Agent Economy: <https://www.buildmvpfast.com/blog/agent-economy-live-marketplace-agent-to-agent-services-2026>
- dealwork.ai: <https://dealwork.ai/>
- DEV Community “12 Platforms”: <https://dev.to/kirothebot/the-agent-economy-is-real-12-platforms-where-ai-agents-actually-earn-money-may-2026-5bm2>

Enterprise Adoption

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